

Attachment 10

Data Management Plan

To Renounce Liberty? A Public-Goods Experiment on (Un)Democratic Reversal

Janne Tukiainen | janne.tukiainen@utu.fi | Version 2.0 | 31 August 2026

1. Data and documentation

The project will create a structured oTree dataset for 300 completed adult participants in approximately 28–30 matching pools of 10 or 15. The research data include participant and session codes; pool size and temporary-group identifiers; randomized recovery or persistence assignment; institutional ballots; leader selection; proposed allocations and transfers; approval decisions; fallback allocations; payoffs; response times and delay flags; practice and comprehension responses; unpaid expectations; and the final questionnaire. The questionnaire includes views about group approval and limits on a leader’s authority and may therefore reveal political opinions.

The experimental interface does not require names, contact details, national identification numbers, audio, video, location tracking, or free-text responses. Limited technical logs may be generated for security and troubleshooting. PCRC recruitment, scheduling, and payment records are operational records held separately from the experimental dataset.

Data will be exported in open, non-proprietary or widely supported formats such as CSV, with analysis code and documentation in text-based formats. A data dictionary, variable labels, treatment-assignment record, session log, code version, and processing history will document provenance and allow the analysis to be reproduced.

2. Collection, quality, and version control

oTree records entries directly from participant screens. The software prevents participants from entering values outside the permitted limits. Guided practice and five comprehension questions precede paid rounds. The system records response times but does not create random answers or automatically advance strategic decisions. Laboratory staff document technical interruptions and manual prompts in a session log.

Before production, technical and behavioral pilots will test both treatment branches, synchronized waits, 10- and 15-person pools, mixed-pool sessions, rematching, refresh recovery, exports, and payment calculations. Production code and the analysis plan will be versioned and frozen after pilot revisions. Data collection is planned for 1–31 October 2026. Raw exports will be preserved read-only; cleaning will occur through scripted transformations that create derived files rather than overwriting raw data.

3. Legal and ethical basis

TOKA registration records acceptance of PCRC’s general rules and TOKA privacy notice. oTree separately records a concise, study-specific ethical consent before experimental decisions. Personal-data processing is necessary for scientific research carried out in the public interest under GDPR Article 6(1)(e) and the Finnish Data Protection Act (1050/2018), section 4(3); consent to participate is not used as the GDPR processing basis. Because questionnaire responses may reveal political opinions, the project also applies GDPR Article 9(2)(j) and section 6(1)(7) of the Finnish Data Protection Act, with Article 89 safeguards. Data minimisation, pseudonymisation, access restriction, separation of operational identifiers, and de-identified reporting are applied throughout.

4. Storage, security, and access

Production data will be collected through oTree hosted on a University of Turku IT server with an utu.fi domain in Finland. Coded research data and backups will remain on storage provided or approved by University IT. The public prototype will not collect live research data. No personal data are transferred outside the EU or EEA.

During the project, research data will be stored on University IT-provided servers protected by institutional credentials, role-based access, encrypted connections, managed backups, and two-factor authentication where available. Local working copies will be limited to encrypted University-managed devices and removed when no longer needed. Email and portable unencrypted media will not be used to transfer research data.

Access to coded research data will be limited to Janne Tukiainen, Hector Bahamonde, and authorised personnel who need it for collection, quality control, analysis, or data management. PCRC retains identifying recruitment, scheduling, attendance, and payment information but does not receive the research analysis dataset. Researchers receive only coded experimental data. External collaborators will receive only anonymised data unless controller roles, access needs, and data-protection agreements are documented in advance.

5. Pseudonymisation and participant rights

PCRC assigns the code used to enter the laboratory session and keeps the temporary identity-to-code link separate from research responses. The research team does not receive this link. PCRC deletes it once compensation has been paid. The oTree export records the study-specific consent response, form version, and timestamp. Pool size and group identifiers remain because they are required for randomization and analysis, but they will not be published in a form that permits re-identification through small cells.

Participants are informed through a participant information sheet and privacy notice. Before payment, applicable requests concerning the experimental record are directed to Janne Tukiainen and handled with PCRC and, where appropriate, the University Data Protection Officer. After PCRC deletes the link, the research team cannot locate an individual's coded record, consistent with GDPR Article 11.

6. Retention, sharing, and disposal

Coded research data without direct identifiers will be retained on University IT-provided storage for analysis, verification, and compatible future scientific research. PCRC deletes the identity-to-code link after payment. The retention need will be reviewed five years after publication of the primary results and at regular intervals thereafter; data no longer necessary for an approved scientific purpose will be securely deleted or irreversibly anonymised. Anonymised data, metadata, analysis code, and non-identifying experimental materials may be preserved for reproducibility and future scientific use.

The project follows the University of Turku principle that research outputs should be as open as possible and as closed as necessary. A disclosure-risk review will precede any release. Public replication files will exclude participant labels, session dates or other indirect identifiers that create re-identification risk, rare small-cell combinations, and any variables that cannot be shared lawfully. Where a useful dataset cannot be fully anonymised, metadata and code may be public while data access remains restricted or is not offered.

7. Responsibilities, incidents, and resources

Janne Tukiainen, as Principal Investigator, is responsible for project oversight and serves as the project contact. Hector Bahamonde supports the implementation and updating of this plan, data documentation, and coordination with PCRC, University data support, and the Data Protection Officer. Authorised team members are responsible for confidentiality and secure handling. Suspected loss, unauthorised access, or disclosure will be reported promptly through University incident procedures, access will be contained, and notification duties will be assessed with the controller and Data Protection Officer.

Data-management costs are modest and include secure institutional storage, staff time for documentation and disclosure review, and any approved repository or controlled-access service. The plan will be reviewed after pilots, before production, and whenever the platform, collaborators, collected variables, or sharing plan changes materially. The final DMP may also be recorded in DMPTuuli, as recommended by the University of Turku.